

ISLAM, SCIENCE AND ATHEISM

**Scientific Knowledge Facilitates or
Negates the concept of God?**

Umair Gulzar

Lecturer

0322-7191913

Table of Contents

Scientific Knowledge Facilitates or Negates the concept of God?	3
Cosmology and Creation:	5
The Early Universe	5
The Cosmic Dark Ages and Reionization.....	5
Creation Ex Nihilo Conscious or Unconscious.....	8
Violation of Certified laws is the irrefutable evidence of Creation:	8
Violation of first law of thermodynamics:.....	9
Violation of Second law of thermodynamics:.....	9
Structure of an Atom as evidence of Creation.....	11
Creation or Darwinism	12
Structure of DNA and Sequence Hypothesis.....	12
The reality of by chance and self-made argument.....	15
One of World's Leading Atheists Antony Flew Now Believes in God,	16
On the Origin of Everything: A Mathematical and Philosophical Exploration.....	17
Mathematical Foundation	17
Philosophical and Theological Interpretation	18
God as the First Cause	18
The Uniqueness of 1	18
Conclusion	18
Islam and Science	19
Origin of the Universe and Life.....	19
There was initial gaseous phase.....	20
Embryology and the Quran	21
Geology and the Quran.....	22
The Female Bee	23
Expanding Universe:	24
The Qur'anic View of The Expansion of the Universe	24
360 joints in human body	25
The light of Moon.....	26

Small brain in the heart.....	26
Scientists converted to Islam because of Scientific knowledge	27
How Dr. Maurice Bucaille Accepted Islam	27
Dr. Gary Miller.....	30
Dr. Lawrence Brown.....	31
Dr Bruno Abd al Haqq Guiderdoni.....	31
Prof. Jackie.....	32
Dr. Okada	32
Final Cocnlusion.....	32

Scientific Knowledge Facilitates or Negates the concept of God?

Existence of God is a question of debate since the history of mankind. We are living in the era of science. The progress in scientific knowledge and developments in AI have drastically changed the scope of life. The questions regarding the existence of God, Creation and sustenance of Universe, Intelligent design, and end of Universe are topic of debate among emerging young minds. There is a perception that has been advocated by the certain people across the globe that why we don't need a creator or religion. According to them, now we are aware of the fact that the universe is functioning according to certain physical laws so there is no room for Creator. As quoted by Stephen Hawkins in his famous book 'The Grand Design' (TGD):

“Because there is a law like gravity the Universe can and will create out of nothing.”

This is need of the hour to address and discuss these topics in a scholarly, mature and unbiased manner.

First of all, we have to understand that Religion and Science are not against each other. As there was a long war between the authorities of Church and Church in earlier centuries in West. Scientists were brutally treated for their different ideas e.g. Galileo. There is a confusion that Religion negates Science and Science negates the concept of Creator. In my humble opinion, Scientific knowledge facilitates us to understand the concept of Creator/God. One should remember that the scope and limits of these two subjects are different from each other.

Science will always discuss and address the question of '**How**'. For example, the stages of creation of chick in the shell of egg and creation of a human child in mother's womb. Which organ develops earlier and which one later, either ears develop earlier or later, liver, stomach, small intestine, large intestine, heart & system of vessels, brain, lungs kidneys, skin, spinal cord so on and so forth with all complexities and complete structures of trillions of cells. Same is the case with the creation of all the species and a chick in egg for 21 days.

The question of '**Who**' is not the domain of science. The question of 'Who' will always remain important and constant.

Who has selected one sperm and one egg out of millions?

Who has converted them into a zygote and then fetus?

Who has converted one cell, (which itself is a universe and comprised of multiple complex structures) into approximately controlled 40 trillion cells.

Who has guided them to be a cell of skin, hair, eye, ears and so on.

With the help of scientific knowledge, we are able to know that the start of the one cell was a result of brilliant flawless design. As all of us are aware that a minute mistake or irregularity during the process of formation will definitely results into the collapse of whole system. Who is guiding them, controlling them and monitoring the whole procedure in mother's womb is a million-dollar question. As we all know that if a mother has the responsibility to take care one of all these procedures, she will not be able to do that. This process of Creation is not the result of parent's consciousness but someone else.

With the help of scientific knowledge, we cannot negate the question of 'Who' rather we are able to answer it in a more appropriate manner. Try to understand this point with the help of this example. Suppose there is fast track train that is accelerating at high speed. A passenger says that the train is moving because of the driver. A second person sees the engine and said that the train is moving because of the kinetic energy produced by the engine. The energy produced by the engine is the reason of moving train. The discovery of engine didn't end the discussion by concluding that now train doesn't need a driver rather it starts a new discussion. The discovery of engine will lead into a new discussion. Who has created the engine so accurately that it can move without any irregularity, by following the complex laws of physics. Again, we are aware that a single irregularity will result in the collapse of whole system. One who has created the engine and make him able to work efficiently and flawlessly is the only reason of moving train.

In the light of afore-mentioned arguments it is evident that Science and Religion are not against each other their domains and scopes are different. Science has its own limits and it cannot answer all the questions. A famous scientist Medawar elaborates this concept in the following words:

"Science is a great and glorious enterprise----the most successful, I argue that human beings have ever engaged in. To reproach it for its inability to answer all the questions we should like to put to its no locomotive for not flying or in general, not performing any other operation for which it was not designed. Similarly questions of morality without which no human or at least humanly life can be imagined are beyond the scope of science."

One can understand that science has a limited scope to answer different domains. Without any doubt science has enlightened us in many ways about the complex functionality of Universe, human beings, structure of atom and facilitates the question of 'Who'. We will look into the details of these ideas.

Cosmology and Creation:

Scientific knowledge has provided us with an idea of creation of universe. The universe began as a **singularity** around 13.8 billion years ago, expanding rapidly in an event known as the Big Bang. According to some scholars, big bang is no more a theory but an established fact as we have observed different energy spectrums. This marked the beginning of cosmic inflation, where the universe expanded faster than the speed of light for a fraction of a second. As inflation stopped, energy transferred to matter and light, forming protons, neutrons, and electrons

The Early Universe

In the first few minutes, protons and neutrons collided, producing the earliest elements: hydrogen, helium, and traces of lithium and beryllium. Around 380,000 years after the Big Bang, the universe cooled enough for atomic nuclei to capture electrons, forming complete atoms. This era, called recombination, made the universe transparent, allowing light to travel freely.

The Cosmic Dark Ages and Reionization

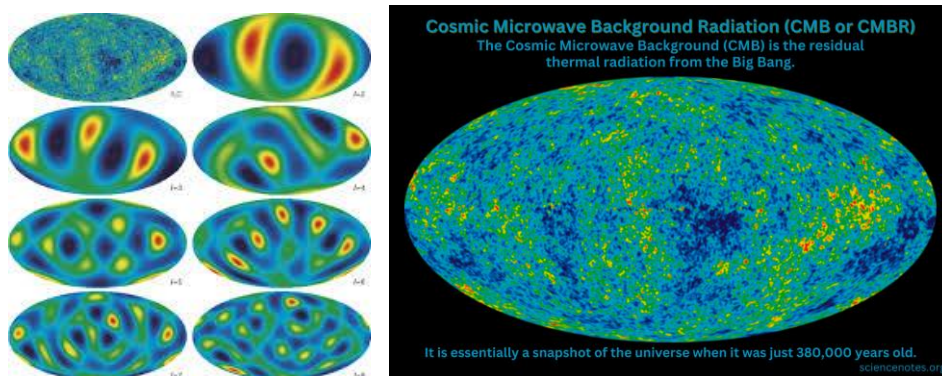
The universe then entered the cosmic dark ages, lasting around 200 million years, before the first stars formed. These stars were massive, 30-300 times bigger than our Sun, and millions of times brighter. Their ultraviolet light broke down hydrogen atoms, reionizing the universe. This process, occurring around 1 billion years after the Big Bang, transformed the universe, making it transparent to light as we see it today.



In the light of aforementioned references, the expected idea of universe creation has been discussed. All the scholars admit the fact that our universe infinitely huge and we are not able to comprehend the dimensions of universe. As per the latest report of Jame's Web telescope, the observable universe is more than 46 billion light-years in any direction from Earth and about 93 billion light-years in diameter. The scientists says that we know

the universe more than ever but we only know about the grain of one sand on the tip of finger of a desert. We've discovered a staggering number of galaxies so far! Estimates suggest there are approximately 100 billion to 2 trillion galaxies in the observable universe. The Milky Way galaxy is enormous, measuring: Diameter: approximately 100,000 to 200,000 light-years and estimated 200-400 billion stars, 100-400 billion solar masses. All these galaxies are working according to complex physical laws.

The point to be pondered over is the start of this enormously huge and complex expanding universe was from singularity. This singularity has been named cosmic egg, nebula whose density was infinite and volume was zero (creation ex nihilo). This idea was proposed by Sir Edwin Hubble for the first time in 1929. For the first time he observed that all the objects of universe are moving away from each other. This expansion was evidence that all the stars which are moving away were started from a single point. That is why they are moving away from each other. This is an admitted fact that the universe evolves from a singular mass i.e. matter. Further more in 1965 Arno Penzias and R.W Willson discover the cosmic microwave background radiation. They were awarded noble prize for this discovery. The cosmic microwave background radiation is the faint remnant glow of the big bang. This false color image, covering about 2.5 percent of the sky, shows fluctuations in the ionized gas that later condensed to make superclusters of galaxies. CMBR is a second piece of evidence to show the expansion of space, and this supports the Big Bang model of the origin of the Universe. The short wavelengths of the gamma radiation emitted in the initial explosion are believed to have become stretched due to the expansion of space into longer wavelength microwaves.



The question arises what was there before big bang? We are aware of the fact mentioned in first law of thermodynamics that matter can never be created nor it can be destroyed. How the first matter came into existence when there was no matter to divide or transform out of nothing? Stephen Hawkins suggests in his book TGD:

“We are a product of quantum fluctuations in the very early universe and laws of nature, universe has been emerged out of nothing.”

Fact of the matter is, nothing is no more nothing in Physics. Because of the laws of quantum mechanics and special relativity, on extremely small scales, nothing is really a boiling bubbling brew of virtual particles that are popping in and out of existence on a time scale so short that we are not able to observe them. Stephen Hawkins and other people who don't believe in creations states that the universe is the result of complex laws. They are the reason behind the creation of Universe. One can read the book TGD for more details in which the same argument is summarized in these words. "Because there is a law like gravity the universe can and will create out of nothing." The whole argument will again end at now we know there is an engine so we don't need to believe in a driver.

The question will again rise that who has guided and directed the laws? Where do these come from? We have seen the stance of the people who negates the concept of creation now we will examine the argument of other scientists. Clive Staples Lewis has refuted the idea of self-creation from laws in a logical manner.

"We are in habit of talking as of laws caused events to happen; but they have never caused the event at all. The laws of motion do not set billiard balls moving: they analyze the motion after something else (say, a man with a cue) has provided it. They create or produce no events: they just state the pattern to which every event — if only it can be induced to happen — must conform, just as the use of arithmetic state the pattern to which all the transactions with money must conform — if only it can get hold of any money. Thus, in one sense the laws of Nature cover the whole space of field and time; in another, what they leave out is precisely the whole real universe — the incessant torrent of actual events which makes up true history. That must come from somewhere else. To think the laws can produce it is like thinking that you can create real money by simply doing sums. For every law, in the last resort, says if you have A, then you will have B. B is the product and dependent of A. To secure B, you first have to catch A, the laws won't do it for you."

Lennox has added:

"Gravity itself is dependent for its existence on the prior existence of matter/energy and space, then how could gravity cause their self-creation out of nothing? The question will remain the same who has created first matter/energy and space and allowed rather guided the matter to evolve in a spectacular manner following the complex principles of physics and quantum physics?"

Creation Ex Nihilo Conscious or Unconscious

Creation ex nihilo (creation out of nothing) is an agreed upon start between two school of thoughts. In the light of afore-mentioned reasoning modern science has no room for creation ex nihilo. In the regard of creation, we have only two possibilities. Firstly, the whole universe came into existence out of nothing literally nothing. The first matter/energy emerged from an entity which was totally unconscious in essence. It gives birth to this infinitely huge, complex and expanding universe which is an embodiment of intelligent design and working on absolute principles of physics, quantum physics and mechanics e.g. gravity, quantum fluctuations and so on. The slightest change or irregularity in any of the principles would result into the collapse of system.

The second possibility is this, there was a whole conscious, flawless, intelligent and eternal being the cause of all the causes. He, not only created the first matter/energy but guided and sustained the whole evolution of universe. Because consciousness, design, absolute principles and electromagnetic forces can never be the product of an unconscious entity. Now, we have to decide which approach is more scientific, intelligent and mature approach. A scholar has rightly quoted the whole scenario in the following words:

“The choice for us in this regard is not between Universe with God or without God. This is not the real choice. The realistic choice is between Universe with God or no Universe at all. If we say that God does not exist than we are also compelled to say that the Universe does not exist. But the Universe is too obvious a fact that we are not in a position to deny the existence of Universe. So, we cannot deny the existence of God.”

Violation of Certified laws is the irrefutable evidence of Creation:

When we delve into further details of the cosmological evidences, there are number of details that will support the argument of creation. Each and every detail of the universe is verily the embodiment of fine tuning. The slightest disorder in formation of universe would fail to lead the life as it is. Modern physics now reveals evidence of intelligent design in the very fabric of the universe. Since the 1950s and 1960s, physicists have recognized that the initial conditions and the laws and constants of physics are finely tuned, against all odds, to make life possible. Even extremely slight alterations in the values of many independent factors—such as the expansion rate of the universe, the speed of light, the masses of quarks, and the precise strength of gravitational or electromagnetic attraction—would render life impossible.

Violation of first law of thermodynamics:

The educated people of this era are aware of the first law of thermodynamics i.e. energy/matter can never be created nor it can be destroyed. It is an established fact that the big bang was a result of striking energy. Scientists have observed this energy in different spectrums. This energy is responsible for the expanding universe. The question will again come. Who has created the first energy/matter when there was no matter? How could the whole universe be created out of nothing, without violating the first law i.e. without creating first energy. There was no source of energy and energy can never be created itself other than by the creator.

Violation of Second law of thermodynamics:

Entropy is called the second law of thermodynamics. Entropy measures the disorder, randomness, or uncertainty of a system. For example, when we will see an explosion the level of destruction or disorder that will be produced will be measured by entropy. There are some key facts associated with entropy. Entropy always increases over time and Energy becomes less organized and more dispersed.

So, if enormous energy causes an explosion it will leads to destruction and disorder. Both of them will increase with the passage of time. For example, if there will be a bomb blast in the room the whole matter of the room will be dislocated. The room can never be organized again without the intervention of an external force. The universe initiated and emerged because of the energy of big bang and this explosion should result into disorder but the observation is contrary to the fact. NASA has tried to answer the question in the following words.

The organization of the universe despite the second law of thermodynamics, which states that entropy always increases, is a fascinating topic. The universe began in a highly ordered state, As the universe expanded and cooled, symmetries were broken, leading to the formation of particles and structures. The second law of thermodynamics dictates that entropy increases over time, but... Gravitational collapse, structure formation, self-organizations and drastic change in temperature are these changes leads to the formation and stability of the universe.

Only a biased person can believe that all this happens without guidance and external intervention. Stability is irrefutable evidence of external intervention. Exception means intervention, when intervention is proved, intervenor is also proved. And intervenor is only the other name of creator, who is God.

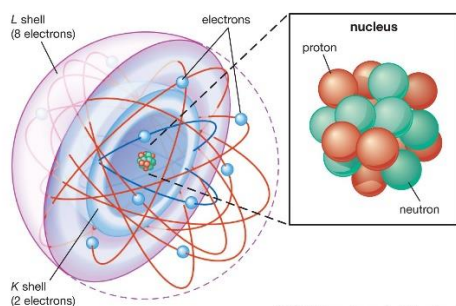
Now some people, will still say that there is no harmony or intelligent design in this Universe. I will request them to see the details of solar flare occurred in this year. Why the earth was saved from the impact of solar flare? Why the electromagnetic forces around are so strong to save it from the devastating effects of the Solar system? Why the

distance between Sun and Earth is finely tuned to make life possible on it. Why the life is only found on earth and not on any other planet? You may find anything in future but till today no empirical evidence of life are found on any place of the universe. A small irregularity among the tectonic plates or a single solar flare can destroy the whole earth in less than a second. God is the only explanation of all the events and stability of the universe.

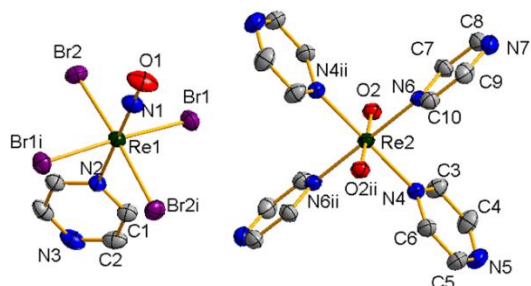


Structure of an Atom as evidence of Creation

The whole universe emerged from a singularity and the smallest unit of the universe is an atom. The structure of an atom is so much complex that itself is like a universe. The stability of the atom is also irrefutable evidence of Creation. The stability of atoms, despite the presence of positively charged protons and negatively charged electrons, is a fundamental concept in physics. When we look into the details, we came to know that stability is the result of Electron Orbitals, Quantum Mechanics, Electromagnetic forces, Nuclear forces, Pauli Exclusion Principle, Energy minimization, Electron screening, nuclear stability. We know all these details because of the advancement of scientific knowledge and millions of dollars investments. Again, these laws are the end result. A minor or slightest change in these principles will result in the collapse of whole structure and stability of the atom. Atom is stable because of these guided and specified laws. It has already been discussed in detail that laws are not the creators. These complex laws which we have learned in the 20th century are not the reason of creation of atoms, billions of years ago out of nothing.



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Creation or Darwinism

In this era the theory of natural selection or Darwinism is considered as an alternative argument against creation. Before Darwin, biologists attributed the beauty, integrated complexity, and adaptation of organisms to their environments to a powerful designing intelligence. As Darwin himself insisted,

“There seems to be no more design in the variability of organic beings and in the action of natural selection, than in the course in which the wind blows.”

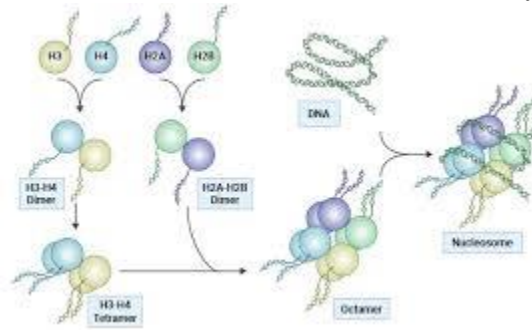
Nevertheless, his theory of evolution by natural selection did not attempt to explain the origin of life—the origin of the simplest living cell—in the first place. Yet there now is compelling evidence of intelligent design in the inner recesses of even the simplest living one-celled organisms. Moreover, a key feature of living cells—one that Darwin knew nothing about—has made the intelligent design of life scientifically detectable. Darwin knew nothing about DNA, how information is stored, translated and specified through amino acids.

Structure of DNA and Sequence Hypothesis

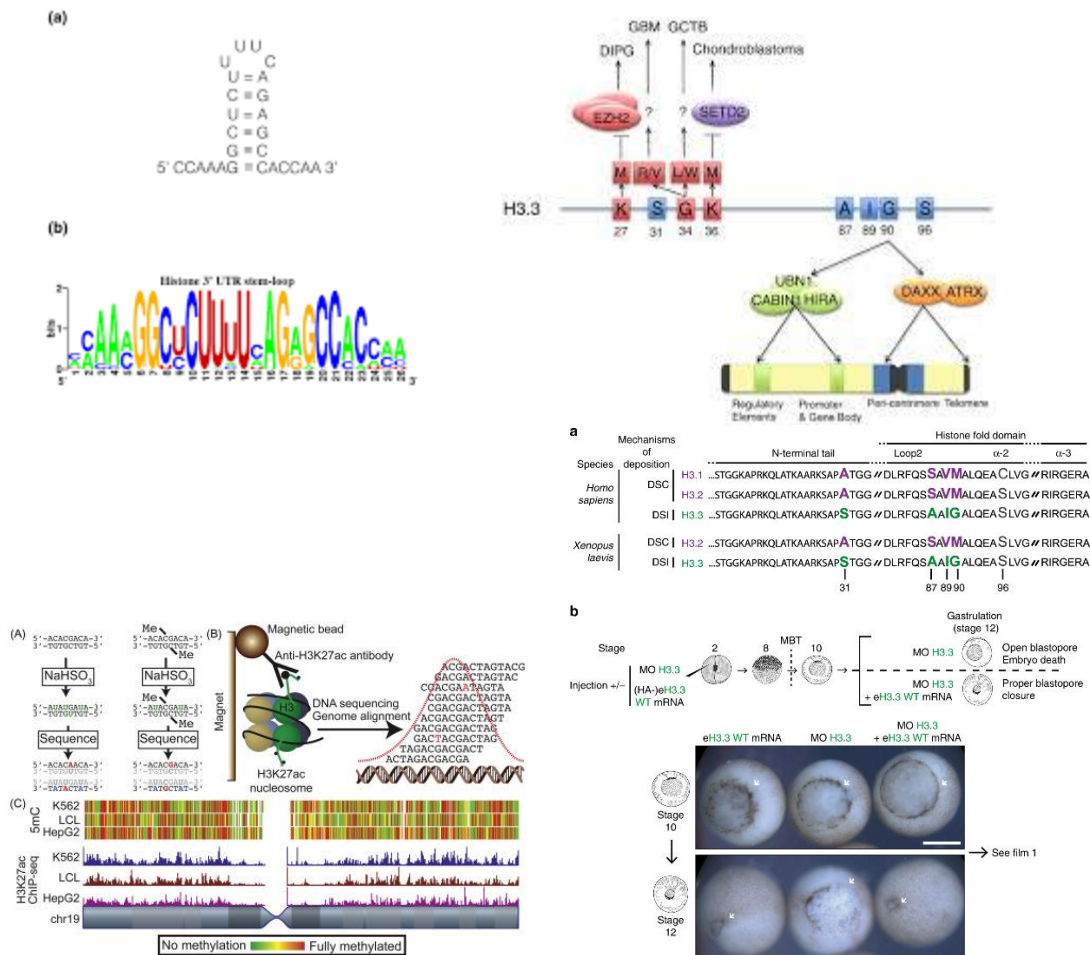
In 1953, when Watson and Crick elucidated the structure of the DNA molecule, they made a startling discovery. The structure of DNA allows it to store information in the form of a four-character digital code. Strings of precisely sequenced chemicals called nucleotide bases store and transmit the assembly instructions—the information—for building the crucial protein molecules and machines the cell needs to survive. Francis Crick later developed this idea with his famous **“sequence hypothesis,”** according to which the chemical constituents in DNA function like letters in a written language or symbols in a computer code. Just as letters of the English alphabet may convey a particular message depending on their arrangement, so too do certain sequences of chemical bases along the spine of a DNA molecule convey precise instructions for building proteins. The arrangement of the chemical 7 characters determines the function of the sequence as a whole.

Strands of DNA are wrapped around spool-like structures called nucleosomes. These nucleosomes are made of proteins called histones. And, again, it is the specific shape of the histone proteins that enables them to do their job. Histones 3 and 4, for example, fold into well-defined three-dimensional shapes with a precise distribution of positive electrical charges around their exteriors. This precise shape and charge distribution enables DNA strands to coil efficiently around the nucleosome spools and

store an immense amount of information in a very small space.



But proteins have a second type of specificity—one that helps to explain the first. Proteins do not just display a specificity of shape; they also display a specificity of arrangement. Whereas proteins are built from rather simple amino-acid “building blocks,” their various functions depend crucially on the specific arrangement of those building blocks. The specific sequence of amino acids in a chain and the resulting chemical interactions between amino acids largely determine the specific three-dimensional structure that the chain as a whole will adopt. Those structures or shapes determine what function, if any, the amino acid chain can perform in the cell—whether as an enzyme, structural component, or a machine for processing inform



When anyone ponder over these images, he will be able to understand the complexity of the structure. These coding's are simply beyond human consciousness to understand. biologist Richard Dawkins notes that “*the machine code of the genes is uncannily computer-like.*” Similarly, Bill Gates observes that “*DNA is like a computer program, but far, far more advanced than any software we’ve ever created.*” Biotechnologist Leroy Hood likewise describes the information in DNA as “*digital code*”.

Where did the information in the cell come from? And how did the cell’s complex information processing system arise? These questions lie at the heart of contemporary origin-of-life research. Clearly, the informational features of the cell manifests design. The information in DNA also defies explanation by reference to the laws of chemistry. Saying otherwise is like saying a newspaper headline might arise from the chemical attraction between ink and paper. Clearly something more is at work. In the Design Inference, mathematician William Dembski explicates the logic of design detection. His work reinforces the conclusion that the specified information present in DNA points to a designing mind.

The reality of by chance and self-made argument

The argument is very simple if someone still thinks that these sequences doesn't exhibit design rather it is arbitrary and by chance. He should also believe that whole systems of coding of the machineries have emerged without design and any irregularity with in them will cause no harm to the functioning. He should also believe that if he has the digits from 1-9 he can figure my exact mobile number without any external help. Only an ignorant person will believe so. Any sound, mature, intellectual and scientific mind can never refute the argument of design. As the Universe and all living beings have been created, they have an initial point. Whatever begins to exist has a cause 'The universe began to exist'. Therefore, the universe has a cause of its existence.

Now consider that there are only 1080 protons, neutrons, and electrons in the observable universe. Thus, if the odds of finding a functional protein by chance on the first attempt had been 1 in 1080, we could have said that's like finding a marked particle—proton, neutron, or electron (a much smaller needle)—among all the particles in the universe (a much larger haystack). Unfortunately, the problem is much worse than that. With odds standing at 1 chance in 10164 of finding a functional protein among the possible 150-amino-acid compounds, the probability is 84 orders of magnitude (or powers of ten) smaller than the probability of finding the marked particle in the whole universe. Another way to say that is the probability of finding a functional protein by chance alone is a trillion, trillion, trillion, trillion, trillion, trillion, trillion times smaller than the odds of finding a single specified particle among all the particles in the universe.

In 1983 distinguished British cosmologist Sir Fred Hoyle calculated the odds of producing the proteins necessary to service a simple one-celled organism by chance at 1 in $10^{40,000}$.

What does this mean? It means that if every event in the universe over its entire history were devoted to producing combinations of amino acids of the correct length in a prebiotic soup (an extravagantly generous and even absurd assumption), the number of combinations thus produced would still represent a tiny fraction—less than 1 out of a trillion trillion—of the total number of events needed to have a 50 percent chance of generating a functional protein—any functional protein of modest length by chance alone.

As far as the transformation of one specie into another specie is concerned. There is no empirical evidence of that. It has been supposed from archeological and other evidences. There is no observational evidence that a goat has been evolved into a giraffe in front of us. The strongest argument in this regard is that human beings have been evolved from chimpanzees. What has been evolved from human beings? When any distinct specie will evolve from human beings I will believe in the argument of evolution.

But until then everyone has a choice to choose between the two on the basis of scientific and empirical evidences. The readers can make their own choice.

One of World's Leading Atheists Antony Flew Now Believes in God,

A British philosophy professor who has been a leading champion of atheism for more than a half century has changed his mind. He now believes in God more or less based on scientific evidence,

To the surprise of all concerned, I announced at the start that I now accepted the existence of a God. Yes, I now think it does . . . almost entirely because of the DNA investigations. What I think the DNA material has done is that it has shown, by the almost unbelievable complexity of the arrangements which are needed to produce (life), that intelligence must have been involved in getting these extraordinarily diverse elements to work together. It's the enormous complexity of the number of elements and the enormous subtlety of the ways they work together. The meeting of these two parts at the right time by chance is simply minute. It is all a matter of the enormous complexity by which the results were achieved, which looked to me like the work of intelligence.

On the Origin of Everything: A Mathematical and Philosophical Exploration

Another argument that has been discussed a lot is the argument of infinite recession. It means that if God has created everything, who has created God? This question has created and will create ambiguity in the mind of people because they consider God as one of them. All the rules can not be applied on everything equally. For example, it is very easy to figure out the start and end point a vertical and horizontal thing but if someone has to figure out the start and end point of a circle or round ball it wouldn't be possible. The fundamental problem lies in the idea that God is like us and we can comprehend him, he has a starting and end point and all the physical laws and parameters of time also applicable on him. The only explanation of all the aforementioned arguments is that God can never fall under those parameters as he is the creator of them. If Creator is like creation then there will be no point of a supreme creator. There was a time when there was no concept of time but he existed as he is the creator of time as well. Now the point is, if God is also created then he can never be a creator. As nothing can be produced from nothing similarly nothing can be created from 0. We have to believe in an eternal 1 for the start of all the things.

The statement, "Everything starts with 1," carries deep mathematical, philosophical, and theological implications. In this document, we analyze this assertion in the context of a mathematical recurrence relation and extend its significance to the existence of God as the foundational principle of all that exists.

Mathematical Foundation

Consider the recurrence relation:

$$a_{n+1} = f(a_n),$$

where each term of the sequence a_n is defined as a function of the preceding term. Let us assume the initial condition $a_0 = 1$. This setup implies the following:

1. Initial Condition: **The entire sequence depends fundamentally on the initial term $a_0 = 1$. Without this initial condition, the sequence cannot exist.**
2. Recursive Dependency: Each subsequent term a_{n+1} is entirely determined by the preceding term a_n through the function f . The sequence exists only because of the existence of a_0 .

This mathematical structure suggests that all processes trace back to an initial condition or a starting point, which we symbolically denote as 1.

Philosophical and Theological Interpretation

The concept of $a_0 = 1$ can be interpreted philosophically as a representation of the First Cause or the foundational principle, often associated with God in theological discourse. This idea aligns with the classical argument of the Causa Prima (First Cause), which asserts:

There must exist a necessary and fundamental origin from which all existence is derived.

God as the First Cause

In the recurrence $a_{n+1} = f(a_n)$, the existence and structure of the entire sequence rely on the existence of the initial term $a_0 = 1$. Analogously:

- God is the ultimate origin of all creation, the uncaused cause that explains the existence of the universe.
- Just as $a_0 = 1$ initiates the sequence, God serves as the foundational principle upon which all things depend.

The Uniqueness of 1

The choice of $a_0 = 1$ is not arbitrary. The number 1 holds special significance in mathematics:

- It is the multiplicative identity: $1 \cdot x = x$ for all x .
- It represents unity and indivisibility.

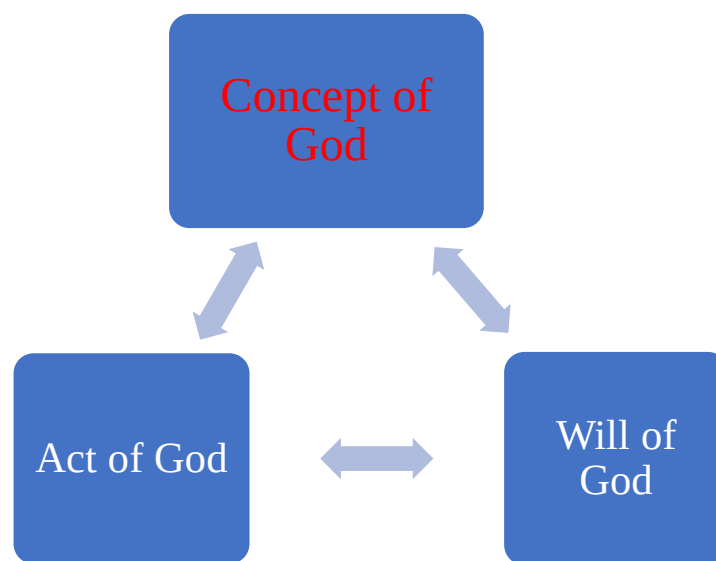
In theology, these properties resonate with the concept of God as One, the singular and all-encompassing source of existence, as emphasized in monotheistic traditions.

Conclusion

The recurrence relation $a_{n+1} = f(a_n)$ illustrates the dependency of all subsequent terms on an initial condition $a_0 = 1$. Mathematically, this highlights the necessity of a starting point. Philosophically and theologically, it aligns with the notion of God as the First Cause and the ultimate source of all existence. Thus, the statement “Everything starts with 1” is not only a mathematical truth but also a profound reflection of a greater metaphysical reality.

Islam and Science

It has been discussed earlier that all the Religions are divided in 2 major categories on the basis of revelation. Sematic and Non-Sematic Religions. In non-Sematic religions mostly the concept of the God is ambiguous as they believe in man-made God. In sematic Religions the concept of God is totally different. The God is the one who is eternal, unique absolutely alone and uncreated. The levels of authenticity of sacred books have been discussed in earlier chapter. So, the focus will remain on the Quran. In order to understand the concept of God in Islam one should be aware of this fundamental phenomenon.



When the concept of God will be clear than everything else will be clear. Majority of the people who do have ambiguities and problems with Islam, all of them will fall under the categories of Act of God and Will of God which will automatically be clear if the Concept of God will be clear. As discussed in the chapter of Mathematical explanation, God is not like creation that is why He is God. The Universe is act of God and more than 1000 verses of the Quran deals with the physical phenomena of Nature. Whatever has been revealed in the Quran 1400 years ago was communicated through Prophet Muhammad peace be upon him. So, to testify the authenticity of Islam we can have a simple parameter.

1. Muhammad was an Apostle of God	2. Muhammad was a Lier.
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Origin of the Universe and Life

An interesting characteristic of the Quran is how it deals with surprising phenomena which relate not only to the past but to modern times as well. In essence, the Quran is not and old problem. It is still a problem even today - a problem to the non-Muslims that is. For everyday, every week, every year brings more and more evidence

that the Quran is a force to be contended with - that its authenticity is no longer to be challenged! For example, one verse in the Quran (Surah al-Anbiya 21:30) reads:

“Do not the unbelievers see that the heavens and the earth were joined together, then We clove them asunder, and made from water every living thing? Will they not then believe?”

Ironically, this very information is exactly what they awarded the 1973 Noble Prize for - to a couple of unbelievers. The Quran reveals the origin of the universe - how it began from one piece - and mankind continues to verify this revelation, even up to now. Additionally, the fact that all life originated from water would not have been an easy thing to convince people of fourteen centuries ago. Indeed, if 1400 years ago you had stood in the desert and told someone, “All of this, you see (pointing to yourself), is made up of mostly water,” no one would have believed you. Proof of that was not available until the invention of the microscope. They had to wait to find out that cytoplasm, the basic substance of the cell, is made-up of 80% water. Nonetheless, the evidence did come, and once again the Quran stood the test of time.

Dr. Alfred Kroner said that no one could tell 1450 years ago that origin of Sun, Moon and Earth can be same. No one can even bluff about this fact.

There was initial gaseous phase

Scientists say that before the galaxies in the universe were formed, celestial matter was initially in the form of gaseous matter. In short, huge gaseous matter or clouds were present before the formation of the galaxies. To describe initial celestial matter, the word ‘smoke’ is more appropriate than gas. The following Qur’anic verse refers to this state of the universe by the word dhukhan which means smoke.

“Moreover, He Comprehended In His design the sky, And it had been (as) smoke: He said to it And to the earth: ‘Come ye together, Willingly or unwillingly.’ They said: ‘We do come (Together), in willing obedience.’” [Al-Qur’aan 41:11]

Embryology and the Quran

A few years ago, a group of men in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia collected all of the verses in the Quran which discuss embryology - the growth of the human being in the womb. They said, "Here is what the Quran says. Is it the truth?" In essence, they took the advice of the Quran: "Ask the men who know." They chose, as it happened, a non-Muslim who is a professor of embryology at the University of Toronto. His name is Keith Moore, and he is the author of textbooks on embryology - a world expert on the subject. They invited him to Riyadh and said, "This is what the Quran says about your subject. Is it true? What can you tell us?" While he was in Riyadh, they gave him all the help that he needed in translation and all of the cooperation for which he asked. And he was so surprised at what he found that he changed his textbooks. In fact, in the second edition of one of his books, called *Before We Are Born...* in the section about the history of embryology, he included some material that was not in the first edition because of what he found in the Quran was ahead of its time and that those who believe in the Quran know what other people do not know.

Dr. Garry Miller had the pleasure of interviewing Dr. Keith Moore for a television presentation, and we talked a great deal about this - it was illustrated by slides and so on. He mentioned that some of the things that the Quran states about the growth of the human being were not known until thirty years ago. In fact, he said that one item in particular - the Quran's description of the human being as a "leech-like clot" ('alaqah) [Ghafir 40:67] - was new to him; but when he checked on it, he found that it was true, and so he added it to his book. He said, "I never thought of that before," and he went to the zoology department and asked for a picture of a leech. When he found that it looked just like the human embryo, he decided to include both pictures in one of his textbooks.

Although the aforementioned example of man researching information contained in the Quran deals with a non-Muslim, it is still valid because he is one of those who is knowledgeable in the subject being researched. Had some layman claimed that what the Quran says about embryology is true, then one would not necessarily have to accept his word. However, because of the high position, respect, and esteem man gives scholars, one naturally assumes that if they research a subject and arrive at a conclusion based on that research, then the conclusion is valid.

Geology and the Quran

One of Professor Moore's colleagues, Marshall Johnson, deals extensively with geology at the University of Toronto. He became very interested in the fact that the Quran's statements about embryology are accurate, and so he asked Muslims to collect everything contained in the Quran which deals with his specialty. Again people were very surprised at the findings. Since there are a vast number subjects discussed in the Quran, it would certainly require a large amount of time to exhaust each subject. It suffices for the purpose of this discussion to state that the Quran makes very clear and concise statements about various subjects while simultaneously advising the reader to verify the authenticity of these statements with research by scholars in those subjects. And as illustrated by the previous examples of embryology and geology, the Quran has clearly emerged authentic.

The Female Bee

In the 16th chapter (Surah an-Nahl 16:68-69) the Quran mentions that the female bee leaves its home to gather food. Now, a person might guess on that, saying, “The bee that you see flying around - it could be male, or it could be female. I think I will guess female.” Certainly, he has a one in two chance of being right. So it happens that the Quran is right. But it also happens that that was not what most people believed at the time when the Quran was revealed. Can you tell the difference between a male and a female bee? Well, it takes a specialist to do that, but it has been discovered that the male bee never leaves his home to gather food. However, in Shakespeare’s play, Henry the Fourth, some of the characters discuss bees and mention that the bees are soldiers and have a king. That is what people thought in Shakespeare’s time - that the bees that one sees flying around are male bees and that they go home and answer to a king. However, that is not true at all. The fact is that they are females, and they answer to a queen. Yet it took modern scientific investigations in the last 300 years to discover that this is the case. So, back to the list of good guesses, concerning the topic of bees, the Quran had a 50/50 chance of being right, and the odds were one in two.

Expanding Universe:

Astronomer Edwin Hubble revealed for the first time that our galaxy is not the only one. There are many other galaxies in the universe, which are moving in the opposite direction of each other in such a way that their speed also increases as the distance between each other increases. It seems that with the expansion of galaxies, the whole universe has also expanded. The distance between galaxies is also constantly increasing. In 1965, two American physicists Arno Penzias and Robert Wilson proved it. The two scientists worked at Bell Phone Laboratories in New Jersey, USA, and were awarded the Nobel Prize in 1978. Stephen Hawking, one of the top scientists of this century, says about the discovery of the expanding universe:

“The discovery that the universe is expanding was one of the great intellectual revolutions of the 20th century.”

The Qur'anic View of The Expansion of the Universe

It is worth noting that the discoveries that science has made in the 20th century, especially in its last few decades, have been described by the Qur'an 1400 years ago. The Qur'an explains the principle of the expansion of the universe in Surah Al-Fatir as follows:

And We built the heavenly universe with great might. And surely, We are expanding (this universe) more and more.

لَمُوسِعُونَ “The word self clearly indicates the meaning of expansiveness. This verse clearly made it clear that the universe, which Allah almighty has created with power and energy, is expanding and growing in every direction in a broader way. The Qur'an describes the process of expansion as a continuation of the creation of the universe. Undoubtedly, this is a great scientific miracle of the Qur'an.

360 joints in human body

Henry Gray, Frank H. Netter and other scientists have recently discovered that there are 360 joints in the human body. This remarkable fact has been mentioned in hadith of Sahih Muslim. A simple human being 1400 years ago can't even think to discuss this fact without divine guidance.

Every one of the children of Adam has been created with three hundred and sixty joints; (Sahih Muslim # 2330)

The light of Moon

It was believed by earlier civilizations that the moon emanates its own light. Science now tells us that the light of the moon is reflected light. **However**, this fact was mentioned in the Qur'an 1,400 years ago in the following verse:

“Blessed is He Who made Constellations in the skies, And placed therein a Lamp And a Moon giving light.” [Al-Qur'an 25:61]

The Arabic word for the sun in the Qur'an, is shams. It is referred to as siraj, which means a 'torch' or as wahhaj which means 'a blazing lamp' or as diya which means 'shining glory'. All three descriptions are appropriate to the sun, since it generates intense heat and light by its internal combustion. The Arabic word for the moon is qamar and it is described in the Qur'an as muneer, which is a body that gives nur i.e. light. Again, the Qur'anic description matches perfectly with the true nature of the moon, which does not give off light itself and is an inert body that reflects the light of the sun. Not once in the Qur'an, is the moon mentioned as siraj, wahhaj or diya or the sun as nur or muneer. This implies that the Qur'an recognizes the difference between the nature of sunlight and moonlight.

Small brain in the heart

The Quran has discussed the concept of heart brain in number of verses. Dr John Andrew Armour first time introduced the concept of Neuro Nervous Cardiology. The "small brain" in the heart is actually a complex system of nerves and cells that can function independently of the brain. It is comprised of 40,000 neurons.

Scientists converted to Islam because of Scientific knowledge

Mostly the people in Pakistan used to criticize Islam as a product of Arab and Sub continent. When they criticize these Muslims and raise allegations against them, they forget that the leading scientific societies and most intellectual persons are accepting Islam in a great number all over the world. The details of some of the leading scientists are mentioned as follows.

How Dr. Maurice Bucaille Accepted Islam

Maurice Bucaille was born to a French parent and, like his family, he grew up a Christian. After his secondary education, he joined Faculty of Medicine, France University. Later, he became the most renowned and cleverest surgeon ever in modern France, but a story happened to change his life completely. France is known for its unique interest in archeology and heritage. When French Socialist President François Mitterrand assumed power in 1981, France asked Egypt, late in the 80's, for the mummy of Egypt's pharaoh so that it would conduct a string of monumental and processing experiments. Actually, the body of Egypt's most notorious tyrant was transferred to France, and, strangely, the French president and his ministers as well as senior officials in the country lined up near the plane carrying the pharaoh's body and bowed down to him as if he were still alive! After the ceremonies of the royal-like reception to Egypt's pharaoh were over, the tyrant's mummy was carried nearly in the same red carpet reception way he received. Then the mummy was transferred to a special wing at the French Monuments Center, and renowned archeologists, surgeons and anatomists started to conduct a study on this mummy in an attempt to delve into its mysteries.

The senior surgeon and the scientist in charge of the study on this mummy of the Pharaoh was Professor Maurice Bucaille. While the processors were busy making restoration to the mummy, their head (Maurice Bucaille) was thinking otherwise. He was trying to discover how this Pharaoh died when, late at night, he concluded his final analyses. The remains of the salt stuck in his body was shining evidence that he had drowned and that his body was retrieved from the sea swiftly after he drowned; it was also obvious that they rushed to mummify his body so that his body would remain intact!! But Maurice Bucaille puzzled over a question: How did this body — to the exclusion of other mummified bodies of other ancient Egyptians — remain that intact although it was recovered from the sea?" Maurice was busy conducting a final report while thinking as to whether the pharaoh's body was recovered from the sea and mummified immediately after he drowned. But one of his companies whispered in his ear, saying "There is no need to rush about this issue, since the Muslims say that this Pharaoh did drown." At first, he vehemently rejected this and did not believe it, citing

that such a discovery would be reached only through sophisticated, modern and accurate computers.

Another one accompanying him surprised him more when he told him that the Muslims' Qur'an in which they believe narrates the story that says he drowned and that his body remained intact even after he drowned. He got more surprised and kept on asking "Where did the Muslims' Qur'an quote these data from while the mummy was not discovered until 1898, i.e. about 200 years only, given that the Qur'an has been recited by Muslims for over 1400 years, and given also that until a few decades ago the entire mankind including Muslims did not know that the ancient Egyptians had mummified their pharaohs?"

Maurice Bucaille stayed up all this night gazing at Pharaoh's body, thinking deeply of what his fellow researcher told him about the Muslims' Qur'an explicitly establishing that this body was recovered after drowning, while the Christians' Gospel (Matthew and Luca) narrated only the story of Pharaoh when he was chasing Prophet Musa (peace be upon him) without mentioning the fate of his body at all.

"Is it believable that Muhammad (peace be upon him) knew about this over 1,000 years ago while I have only just known it?" he thought.

Maurice spent a sleepless night, and asked for a version of the Torah. But it only furthered Bucaille's astonishment; since even Torah did not narrate that the body was recovered and remained intact due to the processing and restoration, which it did undergo.

France sent back the mummy to Egypt in a splendid glass coffin. But, since he knew about the story circulated by Muslims on the intactness of this body, he decided to pack his baggage and travel to Saudi Arabia where a medical conference happened to be held with a galaxy of Muslim anatomists attending.

There, told them about his discovery, i.e. that Pharaoh's body was kept intact even after he drowned. One of the conferees opened the Qur'an and read out the Ayah in which Allah Almighty said, "So today We will (safely) deliver you with your body that you may be a sign to the ones succeeding you; and surely many among mankind are indeed heedless of Our signs." (Yunus: 92)

In his excitement, he stood before the attendants and loudly said,

"I have converted to Islam and believed in this Qur'an."

Back to France, Maurice Bucaille spent 10 years conducting a study as to how far the recently scientific facts match that mentioned in the Holy Qur'an, trying to reassure himself that the Qur'an has never contradicted with any single scientific fact, so that he eventually came up with the conclusion that Allah Almighty said of the Qur'an, "Untruth does not come up to it before (Literally: between its two hands) it nor from behind it; a successive sending down from (One) Ever-Wise, Ever-Praiseworthy."

He came up with a earth shaking book on the Holy Qur'an which jolted the entire Western states, with the title of the book reading,

‘The Bible, The Qur'an and Science, The Holy Scriptures Examined In The Light Of Modern Knowledge.’

The book sold out and even hundreds of thousands of it were translated from French to Arabic, English, Indonesian, Persian, Turkish and German, extending to include nearly all East and West bookstores; one has come to see it with any Egyptian, Moroccan or Gulf person in the US.

In the preface of his book, Maurice Bucaille said, “These scientific areas which Qur'an established to the exclusion of other Scriptures filled me with deep surprise early on, since it never struck my mind to see such a large amount of scientific issues in such a variable and accurate way that they are a mirror image of what has recently been discovered in a book which has existed for more than 13 centuries.!!

The Bible, The Qur'an and Science, The Holy Scriptures Examined In The Light Of Modern Knowledge was such a marvelous piece of writing that, in the year 1988, the French Academy awarded him its prize in history.

Dr. Gary Miller

In 1977, Professor Gary Miller, the active Canadian preacher and mathematics and logic lecturer at Toronto University, decided to provide a great service to Christianity through exposing scientific and historical errors in the Noble Qur'an in such a way that would be beneficial to him and his fellow preachers in calling Muslims to Christianity. However, the result was completely to the contrary.

In 1978 Professor Miller embraced Islam and called himself Abdul-Ahad. The first surprising issue for Professor Miller was the challenging tone in many verses of the Qur'an such as the verses that can be translated as: Will they not then contemplate the Qur'an? And if it had been from (anywhere) other than the Providence of Allah, indeed they would have found in it many difference(s). ([An-Nisa'](#) 4:82)

He has written a wonderful book 'The Amazing Quran' in which he has proved the authenticity of the Quran.

One thing which surprises non-Muslims who are examining the book very closely is that the Quran does not appear to them to be what they expected. What they assume is that they have an old book which came fourteen centuries ago from the Arabian desert; and they expect that the book should look something like that - an old book from the desert. And then they find out that it does not resemble what they expected at all. Additionally, one of the first things that some people assume is that because it is an old book which comes from the desert, it should talk about the desert. Well, the Quran does talk about the desert - some of its imagery describes the desert; but it also talks about the sea - what it's like to be in a storm on the sea.

Dr. Lawrence Brown

A product of Christian-American ancestry dating back to the year 1677, up until his conversion to Islam in April of 1994, **Dr. Laurence Brown** easily could have passed as an example of a man who lived the stereotypical American dream. A graduate from two Ivy League universities with subspecialty training in ophthalmology, Dr. Brown served as a respected ophthalmologist in the U.S. Air Force for a period of eight years. He was a conceptual Atheist but later on he researched he accepted Islam. He has narrated his journey towards Islam.

The next few years I tried to fulfill my side of the bargain, but failed. I studied Judaism and a number of sects of Christianity, but never felt that I had found the truth. Over time I attended a wide variety of Christian churches, spending the longest period of time in Roman Catholic congregation. However, I never embraced Christian faith. I never could, for the simple reason that I could not reconcile the biblical teachings of Jesus with the teachings of the various sects of Christianity. Eventually I just stayed home and read, and during this time I was introduced to the Holy Qur'an and Martin Lings's biography of the prophet, Muhammad, entitled, Muhammad, His Life Based on the Earliest Sources. During my years of study, I had encountered the Jewish scriptures referencing three prophets to follow Moses. With John the Baptist and Jesus Christ being two, that left one according to the Old Testament, and in the New Testament Jesus Christ himself spoke of a final prophet to follow. Not until I found the Holy Qur'an teaching the oneness of God, as both Moses and Jesus Christ had taught, did I begin to consider Muhammad as the predicted final prophet, and not until I read the biography of Muhammad did I become convinced. And when I did become convinced, suddenly everything made sense. The continuity in the chain of prophethood and revelation, the One-ness of Almighty God, and the completion of revelation in the Holy Qur'an suddenly made perfect sense, and it was then that I became Muslim.

He has also rendered multiple books, Goded, Misgoded, Bearing the true witness and other books.

Dr Bruno Abd al Haqq Guiderdoni

Guiderdoni was born on September 30, 1958, in France into a Christian family, although he was not raised as a Christian. He received his Ph.D. in astronomy from the University of Paris in 1986, and held a post-doctoral fellowship at the French Academy of Sciences for two years before joining the Paris Institute of Astrophysics as an astrophysicist in 1988, which is funded by the French National Center for Scientific Research. His research is primarily concerned with the origin and development of galaxies. In 1992, he was named research director at the Paris Institute of Astrophysics. He served as an associate scientist on the European Space Agency's Herschel Space Observatory and Planck (spacecraft), which were launched on 14 May 2009.

A French convert to Islam, Dr Bruno is an astrophysicist and specialist in galaxy formation and evolution. He has also been listed in the top 500 influential Muslims in the world. Having published more than 140 papers and organized several conferences on science subjects, Bruno also serves as Director of the Observatory of Lyon. Besides, he has published more than 60 papers, specifically on Islamic theology and mysticism. Serving now as the Director of the Islamic Institute for Advanced Studies, he has been organizing many interfaith dialogues and conferences worldwide and conducting various television programs on the area.

Prof. Jackie

Born in Taiwan and a chemical engineer by training, she has won many awards and accolades, including being among 100 Engineers of the Modern Era named by the American Institute of Chemical Engineers; and one of 100 young people in the world expected to be leading 21st-century innovators by Technology Review – the innovation magazine of America’s Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). She became a full professor at MIT at age 35 and was elected to Leopoldina (the German National Academy of Sciences) at just 39. She has authored hundreds of articles in her field of nanostructured materials and devices, and has more than 130 patents issued or pending. She has served on the advisory boards of six start-up companies and a venture capital fund.

Dr. Ying is an American scientist, specializing in nanotechnology and founder of the Singapore Institute of Bioengineering and Nanotechnology. After several years of research on Biology in the Quran, Jackie Ying was particularly amazed by a verse from the Holy Quran (21:30) which explicitly describes the role of water in life. This discovery pushed her to take a deeper interest in the teachings of Islam and from that moment on, she started finding answers to many of the questions she had been asking herself for many years and then she converted to Islam. She has also advocated the scientific fact, when you do biomedical research, you can’t help but be struck by the intricacies of biological systems and how they work. It’s so complicated that the probability of everything falling in place by chance is infinitely small. So, for me it’s simple, there has got to be a Creator and the concept of God in Islam is most scientific, rationale and intellectual.

Dr. Okada

Dr. Okada was shocked to know that someone is born the same and everyone is equal according to Islam.

Final Conclusion

The list of these people will reach to thousands. In the light of aforementioned references, it is categorically proved that a simple human being who was born in Arabia

1400 years ago can not even think of these scientific ideas. The leading scientists and intellectuals of the world after cross verification of his claims change the course of their lives even today. Islam is the choice of mature, intellectual and scientific minds of every era. The problems and ambiguities regarding Islam are because of ignorance and biased approach. The Quran is the last word of Allah the Almighty and it will glorify the hearts and minds of truth lovers till the Day of Judgement.

Resource Books.

- i. The Quran
- ii. A Critical Review of Stephen Hawking's Godless Universe, Dr Junaid Hassan.
- iii. The Amazing Quran, Dr. Garry Miller.
- iv. Signature in the Cell: DNA and the Evidence for Intelligent Design, Stephen C. Meyer.
- v. [file:///C:/Users/Administrator/Downloads/Meyer-SciEvidforCreators20\(2\).pdf](file:///C:/Users/Administrator/Downloads/Meyer-SciEvidforCreators20(2).pdf)
- vi. Article
- vii. Return of the God Hypothesis: Three Scientific Discoveries That Reveal the Mind Behind the Universe, Stephen C. Meyer.
- viii. file:///C:/Users/Administrator/Downloads/sm_returnofgod.pdf
- ix. Article
- x. There is a god How the World's Most Notorious Atheist Changed His Mind Antony Flew with Roy Abraham Varghese
- xi. The Bible, The Qur'an and Science, The Holy Scriptures Examined in the Light of Modern Knowledge. by Dr. Maurice Bucaille